

UTT Chapter 07 Test

MULTIPLE CHOICE [Each question is worth 1 point.]

Choose the correct answer from the choices below.

1. **According to Postmodernism, which of the following affect how we see the world?**
 - a. Culture
 - b. Language
 - c. Gender
 - d. All of the above [7.2]
 - e. None of the above
2. **According to Postmodernism, truth is what?**
 - a. Objective
 - b. Universal
 - c. Neutral
 - d. Socially constructed [7.2]
 - e. A and B only
3. **Postmodernists claim that we can have what type of access to reality?**
 - a. Unmediated
 - b. Direct
 - c. Immediate
 - d. All of the above
 - e. None of the above [7.2]
4. **Which Postmodernist philosopher famously pronounced, “God is dead”?**
 - a. Friedrich Nietzsche [7.3]
 - b. Michel Foucault
 - c. Walter Truett Anderson
 - d. Jean-Francis Lyotard
 - e. Richard Rorty
5. **According to Postmodernism, language functions as what?**
 - a. A means for describing objective reality
 - b. A method for communicating truth
 - c. A tool of power and manipulation [7.4d]
 - d. A and B only
 - e. None of the above

- 6. Postmodernists doubt the objectivity of which of the following disciplines?**
- a. Evolutionary biology
 - b. Science
 - c. Math
 - d. A and B only
 - e. All of the above [7.6]
- 7. According to Postmodernism, human beings are what?**
- a. Bodies and souls
 - b. Persons
 - c. Centralized personalities
 - d. Social constructs [7.7b]
 - e. A and B only
- 8. According to Postmodernism, the problem with humanity is our adherence to what?**
- a. Sophism
 - b. Nihilism
 - c. Metanarratives [7.7c]
 - d. A and B only
 - e. None of the above
- 9. Postmodernism rejects the metanarrative inherent in which of the following worldviews?**
- a. New Spirituality
 - b. Secularism
 - c. Marxism
 - d. All of the above [7.8]
 - e. A and B only
- 10. On what point can Christians and Postmodernists find some agreement?**
- a. Our culture plays a role in shaping who we are.
 - b. Our experiences contribute to who we are.
 - c. Language can be used to manipulate people.
 - d. All of the above [7.8a]
 - e. None of the above
- 11. On what point can Christians and Postmodernists find some agreement?**
- a. We cannot judge between competing ideas.
 - b. We cannot perceive reality as it actually is.
 - c. All language is manipulative.
 - d. All of the above
 - e. None of the above [7.8a]

TRUE OR FALSE [Each question is worth 1 point.]

Indicate if each statement is true or false. If the statement is false, alter it to make it true.

12. Postmodernism asserts that all worldviews offer unbiased truth claims about reality.

False: biased [7.2]

13. According to Postmodernism, universal truth can be known.

False: cannot [7.2]

14. Postmodernists do not believe we can have objective knowledge.

True [7.2]

15. According to Postmodernism, things do not have essences.

True [7.2]

16. Postmodernists claim that the notion of subjective truth is used to oppress others.

False: objective [7.2]

17. Nietzsche predicted that once we killed our belief in God, all truth, meaning, and morality would continue to exist without him.

False: die along with him [7.3]

18. Deconstruction says that the reader's interpretation is more important than the author's intent.

True [7.4c]

19. According to Postmodernism, there is meaning in the text.

False: is no [7.4c]

20. Postmodern literary criticism claims that words cannot accurately describe objects in the world.

True [7.4c]

21. According to Postmodernism, words are about things.

False: words, not about things [7.4c]

22. Postmodernism rejects all metanarratives.

True [7.6]

23. According to Postmodernism, science cannot tell us what is true, only what scientists believe to be true.

True [7.6]

24. To Postmodernists there is no such thing as human nature.

True [7.7b]

25. Postmodernism and middle-way Buddhism share a similar view of truth.

True [7.7e]

FILL-IN-THE-BLANK [Each question is worth 2 points.]

Fill in the missing word to complete each statement.

26. Modernism [7.2] is characterized by a strong belief in human reason, empiricism, science, and technological progress as a well as skepticism toward religion.

27. Nihilism [7.3] is the belief that the world and human existence are without meaning, purpose, truth, or essential value.

28. The Sophists [7.3] were a group of people who practiced constructing persuasive arguments, regardless of whether or not they were true.

29. Structuralism [7.4a] is an intellectual movement that believes human knowledge is not based on an accurate understanding of reality but is the product of linguistically constructed forms or grammars that societies have developed over time.

30. Poststructuralism [7.4b] is an intellectual movement that contends human communication is not really about things but about the views and motivations of those involved in the conversation.

31. Deconstruction [7.4c] is a method of literary analysis that seeks to expose the underlying ideologies of a text.
32. Jean-Francis Lyotard described Postmodernism as an “incredulity toward metanarratives [7.4d].”
33. Anti-realism [7.4d] is the denial of the existence or accessibility of an objective reality.
34. Pragmatism [7.7d] contends that propositions don't mirror reality and should therefore be treated as tools and judged by their practical consequences.
35. The hybrid worldview of Christian Postmodernism [7.8a] teaches that since we are fallen and limited, we should demonstrate Christian humility by refusing to make exclusive truth claims.

SHORT ANSWER [Each question is worth 3 points.]

Answer the following questions with at least one sentence.

36. Summarize the Postmodern worldview.

Postmodernism is a skeptical worldview founded as a reaction to modernism that is suspicious of metanarratives and teaches that ultimate reality is inaccessible, knowledge is a social construct, and truth claims are political power plays. [7.1]

ESSAY [Each question is worth 4 points.]

Answer the following questions with at least one paragraph.

37. What is the history between Marxism and Postmodernism?

Many Postmodernists were once atheistic Marxists. After Marxism's slaughter of millions, however, many within the movement become disillusioned with its promise of a future utopian society. They abandoned the dream of communism, in favor of a worldview that rallied against all metanarratives. Having been infected by the hypnotizing power of the Marxist metanarrative, Postmodernists saw the power metanarratives have over human beings. When people believe a particular worldview is true, they are usually willing to act on their beliefs. As the history of Marxism has shown us, they are willing to do just about anything. Postmodernism, thus, became a movement against metanarratives and any one worldview claiming to possess truth about the world. [7.8c]